

Midterm Assignment: Grading Guide

Instructor Reference for Objective Assessment

Prompt Engineering Course

Grading Philosophy

This rubric is designed for **objective, efficient grading** with minimal subjectivity. Each criterion has clear indicators for full credit, partial credit, or no credit.

Time estimate: 15–20 minutes per student submission.

Quick Grading Workflow

1. Verify submission format (PDF, all parts present) — deduct 5 points if incomplete
 2. Grade each part using the rubrics below
 3. Check word counts — deduct 1 point per section if significantly over/under (>20%)
 4. Verify screenshots are included and readable
 5. Total points and provide brief feedback (2–3 sentences per part)
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1 Part 1: Prompt Comparison Analysis (30 points)

Detailed Rubric

Criterion	Points	Indicators
Task description clear and appropriate Partial (2): Domain stated but task somewhat vague Minimal (1): Domain stated but task unclear None (0): Missing or inappropriate	3	Full (3): Domain stated, task is specific and realistic
Version A demonstrates vague prompting Good (3): Somewhat vague but has some detail Partial (2): Not clearly distinguishable from Version B Minimal (1): Minimal difference from Version B	4	Full (4): Clearly lacks specificity, context, constraints

Criterion	Points	Indicators
None (0): Missing		
Version B applies ≥ 3 techniques with labels Good (7–8): 3 techniques applied, labels may be incomplete Partial (5–6): 2 techniques, labeling unclear Minimal (2–4): 1–2 techniques, techniques not clearly identified None (0–1): No clear improvement or missing	9	Full (9): 3+ techniques correctly applied and labeled (role, delimiters, few-shot, CoT, structured output, etc.)
Screenshots included for both versions Partial (2): Both present but one illegible Minimal (1): One screenshot missing or illegible None (0): No screenshots	3	Full (3): Both screenshots present and readable
Analysis identifies 3+ concrete improvements Good (4): 3 improvements with some specificity Partial (3): 2 improvements or vague descriptions Minimal (1–2): 1 improvement identified None (0): No analysis	5	Full (5): 3+ specific, measurable improvements identified (e.g., “Version B output was 200 words vs. 50 words”, “included specific legal clauses”)
Analysis explains WHY improvements occurred using course concepts Good (5): References concepts with clear connection Partial (3–4): References concepts but connection unclear Minimal (1–2): Generic explanation without course terminology None (0): No explanation	6	Full (6): Explicitly references course concepts (role prompting, context, constraints, etc.) and explains causal relationship clearly
TOTAL	30	

Common Issues to Watch For

- **Too similar:** Version A and B are nearly identical (deduct from criterion 2)
- **Mislabeled techniques:** Student claims “chain-of-thought” but prompt doesn’t show reasoning steps

(deduct from criterion 3)

- **Superficial analysis:** Says “B is better” without specific evidence (deduct from criterion 5)
 - **Missing screenshots:** Common oversight (deduct from criterion 4)
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2 Part 2: Practical Prompt Design (40 points)

Detailed Rubric

Criterion	Points	Indicators
Framework selection justified appropriately Good (4): Good explanation with adequate reasoning Partial (2–3): Justification present but weak reasoning Minimal (1): Framework stated, no justification None (0): Missing	5	Full (5): Clear, logical explanation of why framework suits task with specific reasoning
All framework components present and clearly labeled RACI (4 components): Full (10) = all 4; Good (8) = 3; Partial (5) = 2 IDEA (4 components): Full (10) = all 4; Good (8) = 3; Partial (5) = 2 SMART (5 criteria): Full (10) = all 5; Good (8) = 4; Partial (6) = 3; Minimal (4) = 2 Labels clear: Deduct 2 points if components not labeled	10	CO-STAR (6 components): Full (10) = all 6; Good (8) = 5; Partial (6) = 4; Minimal (4) = 2–3
Prompt is well-structured, clear, and complete Good (4): Minor clarity issues Partial (3): Some confusion or missing details Minimal (1–2): Poorly structured or incomplete None (0): Missing	5	Full (5): Prompt is coherent, specific, actionable, no ambiguity
AI output included with annotations Partial (2): Output included, no annotations	3	Full (3): Output included, student annotated where AI followed framework

Criterion	Points	Indicators
Minimal (1): Partial output None (0): Missing		
Identifies 2+ weaknesses and creates effective refinement prompt Good (6–7): 2 weaknesses, refinement prompt addresses them well Partial (4–5): 2 weaknesses, refinement prompt partially addresses Minimal (2–3): 1 weakness, weak refinement Poor (1): Vague issues, generic refinement None (0): Missing	8	Full (8): 2+ specific weaknesses identified, refinement prompt addresses them directly and effectively
Improved output demonstrates measurable enhancement Good (3): Noticeable improvement Partial (2): Slight improvement Minimal (1): Minimal or unclear improvement None (0): No discernible improvement or missing	4	Full (4): Clear, significant improvement visible in output (more specific, better structured, addresses identified weaknesses)
Framework effectiveness reflection is thoughtful and specific Good (4): Thoughtful but general Partial (2–3): Superficial reflection Minimal (1): Generic statements None (0): Missing	5	Full (5): Evaluates framework strengths/limitations, considers alternatives, demonstrates learning
TOTAL	40	

Framework Component Checklist

Use this to quickly verify components are present:

CO-STAR:

- ☐ Context — background info
- ☐ Objective — clear goal
- ☐ Style — writing style specified
- ☐ Tone — emotional quality

- ☐ Audience — who it’s for
- ☐ Response — format/structure

RACI:

- ☐ Role — AI persona
- ☐ Audience — target reader
- ☐ Context — situation
- ☐ Instructions — clear directives

IDEA:

- ☐ Instruct — main directive
- ☐ Detail — specifications
- ☐ Example — sample/format
- ☐ Adjust — refinement criteria

SMART:

- ☐ Specific — precise output requirements
- ☐ Measurable — quantifiable elements
- ☐ Actionable — practical next steps
- ☐ Relevant — aligned with goal
- ☐ Time-bound — temporal constraints

3 Part 3: Critical Reflection (30 points)

Detailed Rubric

Criterion	Points	Indicators
Skill progression demonstrates clear learning trajectory with specific example Good (5–6): Shows progression, includes example but lacks depth Partial (3–4): Generic progression description, vague example Minimal (1–2): Superficial reflection None (0): Missing	7	Full (7): Articulates evolution from basic to advanced understanding, provides specific “aha moment” with context, explains challenge and solution

Criterion	Points	Indicators
Practical application is realistic, detailed, and uses appropriate frameworks Good (6–7): Good scenario, frameworks identified but justification weak, some challenges mentioned Partial (4–5): Generic scenario or frameworks not clearly identified, challenges vague Minimal (2–3): Unrealistic scenario, no framework identification None (0–1): Missing or completely off-topic	8	Full (8): Realistic scenario, identifies specific frameworks/techniques with justification, anticipates challenges with solutions
Limitations & ethics discussion shows understanding of AI capabilities and responsible use Good (6–7): 2 limitations, ethical consideration present but solution generic Partial (4–5): 1–2 limitations, ethical discussion superficial Minimal (2–3): Vague limitations, minimal ethics discussion None (0–1): Missing or incorrect	8	Full (8): 2 specific limitations identified and explained, relevant ethical consideration with mitigation strategy
Future learning goals are specific and relevant Good (3): Specific goals but connection to learning unclear Partial (2): Generic goals Minimal (1): Vague aspirations None (0): Missing	4	Full (4): Specific goals tied to identified skill gaps with clear direction
Writing is clear, well-organized, and meets word count Partial (2): Minor clarity issues or slightly off word count Minimal (1): Disorganized or significantly off word count None (0): Incomprehensible or missing	3	Full (3): Professional writing, logical flow, within 400–550 words ($\pm 10\%$)
TOTAL	30	

Week 2 Limitations Reference

Students should reference concepts like:

- Hallucinations (making up facts)
 - Context window limits
 - Training data cutoff
 - Cannot reason like humans
 - Struggles with math/logic
 - No real-world grounding
 - Biases in training data
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4 Overall Grading Notes

Automatic Deductions

- **-5 points:** Missing entire part
- **-3 points:** Multiple word count violations (>20% over/under)
- **-2 points:** Missing AI tool specification
- **-2 points:** Poor formatting (illegible, no section labels)
- **-1 point:** Missing cover page with student info

Bonus Opportunities (Optional)

- **+2 points:** Exceptional creativity or insight in application
- **+2 points:** Goes significantly beyond requirements (e.g., tests 3+ frameworks, creates comprehensive brand guide)
- **Maximum bonus:** 3 points (total cannot exceed 100)

Red Flags for Academic Integrity

Watch for:

- Screenshots that don't match prompts described
- Suspiciously perfect outputs (AI-generated reflection about AI use)
- Identical submissions from multiple students
- Prompts copied from online sources without attribution

If suspected, request student to walk through their process in office hours.

5 Efficient Grading Checklist

For each submission:

1. Format check (2 min):

- ☐ PDF format
- ☐ All 3 parts present
- ☐ Cover page with student info
- ☐ AI tool specified

2. Part 1 (5 min):

- ☐ Task description clear (3 pts)
- ☐ Version A is clearly vague (4 pts)
- ☐ Version B has 3+ labeled techniques (9 pts)
- ☐ Screenshots present (3 pts)
- ☐ Analysis identifies 3+ improvements (5 pts)
- ☐ Explains WHY with course concepts (6 pts)

3. Part 2 (6 min):

- ☐ Framework justified (5 pts)
- ☐ All components present and labeled (10 pts) — use checklist
- ☐ Prompt clear and complete (5 pts)
- ☐ Output with annotations (3 pts)
- ☐ Refinement addresses 2 weaknesses (8 pts)
- ☐ Improvement visible (4 pts)
- ☐ Reflection thoughtful (5 pts)

4. Part 3 (4 min):

- ☐ Skill progression with example (7 pts)
- ☐ Practical application with frameworks (8 pts)
- ☐ 2 limitations + ethics (8 pts)
- ☐ Future goals (4 pts)
- ☐ Word count 400–550 (3 pts)

5. Final review (2 min):

- ☐ Apply any deductions
- ☐ Consider bonus (optional)
- ☐ Total score
- ☐ Write 2–3 sentence feedback per part

Total grading time per student: 15–20 minutes

6 Sample Feedback Templates

Part 1 Feedback

Strong submission:

“Excellent comparison. Your Version B effectively used role prompting, few-shot examples, and structured output. Analysis clearly identified improvements (specificity, format, tone) and explained WHY using course concepts. Well done!”

Needs improvement:

“Version B shows some improvement but techniques need clearer labeling. Analysis would benefit from more specific examples (e.g., word count, structural differences). Reference Week 3 concepts more explicitly.”

Part 2 Feedback

Strong submission:

“CO-STAR framework applied comprehensively with all 6 components clearly labeled. Refinement prompt effectively addressed identified weaknesses (specificity, tone). Reflection demonstrates strong framework understanding.”

Needs improvement:

“RACI framework incomplete — missing Context component. Prompt is clear but refinement doesn’t address specific weaknesses. Explain WHY framework was chosen for this task.”

Part 3 Feedback

Strong submission:

“Thoughtful reflection showing clear progression from basic to advanced prompting. Practical application is realistic with appropriate framework choices. Ethics discussion considers hallucination risks and proposes verification steps.”

Needs improvement:

“Reflection is general — provide specific ‘aha moment’ example. Practical application needs concrete framework identification (which Week 3/4 technique?). Discuss LLM limitations from Week 2 more explicitly.”